was running for the Senate. The dinner at which Eisenhower lashed out at Kennedy was attended by six thousand people, the speech was televised, and now the media was giving it extensive coverage.[4]

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McGEORGE BUNDY FOUND KENNEDY MORE THAN DISTRESSED by Eisenhower's statement when he showed up in his bedroom sometime after 8:00 a.m. The national security adviser had no comforting news to share. "Mr. President, there is now hard photographic evidence that the Russians have offensive missiles in Cuba," he told Kennedy. The U-2 overflight of Cuba authorized by Kennedy a few days earlier had revealed the installation in Cuba of surface-to-surface ballistic missiles capable of reaching most of the eastern United States. Bundy had received the news the previous night but decided not to disturb Kennedy, giving him the opportunity to get a good sleep after an exhausting day that included not only the reception of Ben Bella but also campaigning.[5]

Kennedy felt betrayed. "He can't do this to me," said the president to Bundy, meaning Khrushchev. The Soviet leader had broken his public word not to place offensive weapons on Cuba and his private assurances that he would do nothing to upset Soviet-American relations before the November congressional elections. Kennedy called Khrushchev a "fucking liar" and an "immoral gangster" when he met his brother later that day. In September the Soviet ambassador to the United States, Anatoly Dobrynin, had assured the White House on Khrushchev's orders that there would be no escalation over Berlin. On October 4 and 6—only a week before the unexpected news of the missiles reached John Kennedy—Robert Kennedy met with his Soviet contact, the military intelligence officer Georgii Bolshakov, who had visited Khrushchev in Pitsunda in mid-September. Bolshakov recited by heart Khrushchev's new message: no aggravation before the November elections.[6]

Kennedy asked Bundy to summon his key foreign policy advisers to the White House close to lunchtime, the first opening in his busy schedule for the day. As he began the succession of long-scheduled meetings and